

Evgenii Zaitsev

Product Manager · B2B and B2C

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Saint Petersburg · Russian / English · Technical background

PMP (PMI, 2023) · Certified ScrumMaster (2023) · HSE: Master in Management, professional education with distinction

At Samolet, I develop CRM products for sales teams. In my own venture, EmTalk, I work with the team on apps for mental well-being and decision-making. I started as an engineer, so I look at both the user's problem and how a solution works. My cases describe the decisions I made, the actions I took and where the team got to.

Experience & responsibility

Samolet | Apr 2026 - present

Product Manager · Internal CRM products

With the team, reduced time-to-market from 1.5 months to 2 weeks and defect leakage from ~30% to 11%. Responsible for two internal CRM products. Built an analytics product with AI assistance, using Python and Streamlit for dashboards and ClickHouse data analysis.

- Used customer discovery and stakeholder conversations to identify blockers in sales workflows and prioritise fixes.
- Designed an ICONIX-based approach to requirements: user flows, use cases and PlantUML sequence diagrams, reviewed before development.

EmTalk | Feb 2023 - present

Founder / Product Owner

Conducted 50+ customer discovery interviews during research and built a team without an initial budget. Together, released BRET and Decision Matrix on Google Play.

- Defined product strategy, requirements, backlog and priorities.
- Conducted user, market and competitor research; prepared business model and GTM materials.

Freelance / Project engagements | Jun 2023 - Nov 2024

Project / Product Manager

WinLab: Senior Project Manager (outstaff), assortment, checkout system with Kafka and a 1C reporting test launch.

Kickidler: roadmap, RACI, MoSCoW. Also worked on SAP/1C reporting.

- WinLab: with the team, moved the assortment project to business and functional requirements; secured contractor priority for the checkout project. 1C reporting reached a test launch before I left.
- Kickidler: RACI, MoSCoW, roadmap, feature and architectural improvement work.

Statistics & Control / Statcontrol | Jul 2019 - Feb 2023

Technical Product Owner / Project Manager

OptiRamp: discovery, digital twins, forecasting and implementation. Worked in a four-person team on Honeywell DCS and migration automation.

- Worked with Russian and international clients from presales and problem discovery through OptiRamp implementation and testing.
- Introduced Kanban and task evaluation, improved feedback and engineer onboarding.

Gazprom avtomatizatsia | Oct 2017 - Jul 2019

Team Leader

Control systems for gas turbines and gas transport facilities. Engineering and on-site team leadership, including assignments beyond the Arctic Circle.

- Developed control software; contributed to commissioning, FAT and SAT.
- Coordinated the team and delivery, prepared project documentation.

Product stories

Samolet: from user friction to faster delivery

Two CRM products, a newly assembled team and low adoption. I started with discovery and priority fixes, then changed requirements, early QA involvement and analytics.

Context and priorities

I joined a newly assembled team in April 2026. Sales users often chose other tools. Through customer discovery and conversations with sales managers and regional leads, I identified workflow blockers and prioritised fixes.

Discovery and delivery decisions

I designed an ICONIX-based approach to requirements using user flows, use cases and PlantUML sequence diagrams, reviewed before development. We involved QA earlier and introduced human-reviewed AI-generated test cases, automation and SDD.

How a data gap led to a new product

The team needed data to make decisions, but had no product analyst, and preparing reports was difficult. With AI assistance, I built an analytics product in Python and Streamlit to create dashboards and analyse ClickHouse data. When a product analyst joined, they adopted the approach. The product remains in use and has become essential to analytics for internal products.

Team results

We reduced time-to-market from 1.5 months to two weeks and defect leakage from ~30% to 11%. My contribution covered priorities, requirements, early QA involvement and stakeholder collaboration. These were shared results of process changes, not the effect of a single tool.

Work still in progress

Adoption remains a challenge: product metrics have started to improve but are still weak. We continue root-cause analysis and work on workflows and usage habits. Faster delivery alone does not establish product success.

[Read the case online](#)

EmTalk: from research to two apps

I build a project focused on mental well-being and decision-making. Together with the team, we moved from customer discovery to BRET, Decision Matrix and a content website.

Starting point

During research, conducted more than 50 customer discovery interviews and studied the market and competitors. Built a part-time team without an initial budget to explore useful well-being and decision-making scenarios.

My role and actions

Founder and product lead: strategy, market and competitor research, requirements, backlog, prioritisation and team coordination. I prepared the pitch deck, investor materials and a go-to-market plan.

From research to release

Together with the team, brought BRET and Decision Matrix to publication on Google Play. The EmTalk website offers five tests and nine articles, including an article with an audio version.

The products

BRET brings together well-being practices. Decision Matrix helps compare options: its official listing describes categories, Pros & Cons, decision history and AI suggestions for alternatives.

What this experience demonstrates

Founder experience across the product cycle: research, strategy, team coordination and release. My contribution is product and organisational work; the apps and website are a team outcome.

[Read the case online](#)

Systems, teams & approach

WinLab: complex projects and stakeholder management

Flexible assortment matrix

The project aimed to expand regional assortments through local producers and create an opportunity for revenue growth. Discussions with the main stakeholder were tense. I temporarily paused direct communication with them, involved a wider group of stakeholders and heard other perspectives. We then brought leadership into the work. Together with the team, we moved the project to preparing business and functional requirements.

Checkout system and Kafka

Another project involved moving the checkout system from a monolith to microservices and Kafka. My task was to secure priority with contractor Kristall and keep the project on schedule. I challenged their project managers' position using project management practices and set out my next steps. Within a few hours, they accepted my position; the contractor prioritised the project.

1C reporting automation

The main challenge here was working with the business stakeholder. During one project meeting, the accounting team broke off the discussion and left. I had to use escalation. The project progressed during my engagement: a test launch took place before I left.

[Read the case online](#)

Kickidler: Priorities and team collaboration

Context

Software for employee activity monitoring. Worked as Product Manager from July to November 2024.

My role and actions

Introduced RACI and MoSCoW for ownership and prioritisation. Introduced a roadmap and worked with the team on the testing module and architectural improvements.

What this experience demonstrates

Product prioritisation and attention to how teams make decisions and deliver changes.

[Read the case online](#)

Further experience & skills

Statistics & Control: Turning complex systems into manageable work

Context

Worked in a four-person team on Honeywell DCS reverse engineering and scripts for equipment-version migrations. Later moved to OptiRamp, digital twins, forecasting and modelling for Russian and international clients.

My role and actions

Coordinated the team and delivery; worked on requirements, risks and presales. Introduced Kanban, task evaluation, feedback and engineer onboarding processes. Prepared proposals for organisational transformation.

Connection to today's work

This experience helps me understand complex workflows, collaborate with engineering teams and connect requirements to business needs.

[Read the case online](#)

Skills & tools

Product discovery, customer development, stakeholder management, roadmap, prioritisation, Scrum, Kanban. ClickHouse, Streamlit, ICONIX, PlantUML, AI-assisted analytics, SDD. Jira, Figma, PostgreSQL. Python: basic. Russian: native. English: self-assessed B2+/C1.

Education & learning

Peter the Great St Petersburg Polytechnic University - Technical education, master's studies · 2009-2015

HSE · Master in Management - Professional education programme, with distinction · 2021-2022

PMP / Certified ScrumMaster - PMI / Scrum Alliance · 2023

Machine Learning / Deep Learning - SkillFactory · 2022